

Medical Patient Playbook

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MEDICAL PATIENT WELCOME PLAYBOOK

The Forest Cleveland Heights — Staff Guide

THE MEDICAL PATIENT REALITY

Ohio's medical cannabis program has approximately four hundred five thousand active patients. Since adult-use launched in August twenty twenty-four, medical sales have declined fifty-one percent year-over-year. Medical patients now represent only fourteen percent of total market revenue.

However, medical patients have three times the lifetime value of adult-use customers. They purchase more frequently, buy higher quantities, and are more loyal to specific strains and brands. Losing medical patients to competitors is a strategic mistake.

This playbook ensures every medical patient feels welcomed, guided, and valued — not like an afterthought in an adult-use world.

SECTION ONE: THE WELCOME (First 30 Seconds)

When a customer presents an Ohio Medical Marijuana Registry card, your response is:

"Welcome back. I see you are a medical patient. Thank you for choosing The Forest. My name is [Your Name]. I am going to make sure you get exactly what you need today."

Why this matters: Medical patients report feeling "invisible" since adult-use launched. This greeting restores their priority status.

Never say:

- "Oh, you have a medical card?" (sounds surprised, as if medical is rare)
- "The medical section is over there." (sounds dismissive)
- "You know the limits, right?" (sounds impatient)

- "Your medical status gives you access to our full range, including some products reserved for medical patients."
- "Let me verify your registry status quickly, and then we will find your product."

SECTION TWO: REGISTRY VERIFICATION (60 Seconds)

Step 1: Ask for the Ohio Medical Marijuana Registry card and a valid government-issued photo ID.

Step 2: Verify the following:

- Card is not expired.
- Name on registry card matches name on photo ID exactly.
- Photo on ID matches the person in front of you.
- Patient is not a minor (unless accompanied by a registered caregiver with proper documentation).

Step 3: Check the patient's purchase limit in the POS system or the Ohio Registry portal. The limit is a ninety-day supply as determined by their recommending physician. It is not a fixed number.

Step 4: If the patient is close to their limit, say:

"You are at eighty percent of your ninety-day supply limit. You have [X] days remaining in this period. Would you like me to help you plan your purchases to maximize your allowance?"

SECTION THREE: PRODUCT MATCHING BY CONDITION

Use the Medical Patient Concierge tool for personalized recommendations. This section provides quick-reference logic for common conditions.

CHRONIC PAIN

Primary cannabinoids: THC for analgesia, CBD for anti-inflammatory support.

Preferred terpenes: Caryophyllene (anti-inflammatory), Myrcene (muscle relaxant), Linalool (nerve pain).

Recommended products:

- The Standard GG4 (high THC, caryophyllene-dominant)
- Galenas Eleventh Dimension (balanced, anti-inflammatory)
- The Standard Relief Balm 500mg CBD (localized, non-psychoactive)
- Grön Dark Chocolate 1:1 (systemic, long-lasting)

Staff script: "For chronic pain, we want both immediate relief and long-term management. I am recommending our highest-caryophyllene flower for immediate relief, plus a CBD balm for localized application and a 1:1 edible for sustained effects."

INSOMNIA / SLEEP DISORDERS

Primary cannabinoids: THC for sedation, CBN for deep sleep.

Preferred terpenes: Myrcene (sedative), Linalool (calming), Terpinolene (in small amounts).

Recommended products:

- The Solid OG Kush (myrcene-heavy, evening use)
- Grön Dark Chocolate 1:1 (CBN-enhanced, 90-minute onset)
- The Standard Relief Balm (applied to temples and neck before bed)

Staff script: "Sleep requires a two-part approach. We need something to help you fall asleep and something to help you stay asleep. The OG Kush will help you wind down within ten minutes. The 1:1 edible will keep you asleep for six to eight hours. Start with half a piece."

ANXIETY / PTSD

Primary cannabinoids: CBD for anxiolytic effects, low-to-moderate THC to avoid paranoia.

Preferred terpenes: Limonene (mood elevation), Caryophyllene (stress reduction), Pinene (mental clarity).

Avoid: High-THC sativas, high-myrcene indicas (can increase sedation anxiety).

Recommended products:

- Grön Pearls Microdose Mints (1mg THC, precise control)
- The Botanist 1:1 Tincture (balanced, fast-acting, titratable)
- Galenas Eleventh Dimension (limonene-dominant, clear-headed)

Staff script: "Anxiety requires precision, not potency. I am starting you with our lowest-dose option — one-milligram mints. You can take one, wait an hour, and take another if needed. No guesswork. No overwhelm."

NAUSEA / APPETITE LOSS

Primary cannabinoids: THC for appetite stimulation, CBD for gut inflammation.

Preferred terpenes: Myrcene (appetite), Limonene (digestive support).

Recommended products:

- The Solid OG Kush (myrcene-heavy, reliable appetite trigger)
- The Standard Fruit Gummies (predictable dosing, easy to consume during nausea)
- The Botanist 1:1 Tincture (sublingual, bypasses stomach if nausea is severe)

Staff script: "For nausea, we want fast relief that does not require you to eat first. The tincture goes under your tongue and bypasses your stomach. The gummies are easier to keep down than smoking if your nausea is mild."

EPILEPSY / SEIZURE DISORDERS

Primary cannabinoids: High-CBD, low-THC formulations.

Important: Only recommend products the patient's physician has already approved. Do not play doctor.

Recommended products:

- The Standard Relief Balm 500mg CBD (non-psychoactive, safe baseline)
- The Botanist High-CBD Tincture (if available and physician-approved)

Staff script: "I want to be very careful here. I can show you our highest-CBD, non-psychoactive options, but I need you to confirm with your physician that these specific products align with your treatment plan. I am not a doctor, and your safety is my priority."

SECTION FOUR: THE MEDICAL-ADULT-USE BRIDGE

Some medical patients also shop adult-use. This is legal. Here is how to handle it gracefully.

Scenario: Medical patient wants to buy both medical and adult-use products in one visit.

Response:

"Absolutely. I can help you with both. We will process your medical purchase first to maximize your physician-recommended allowance. Then we will process a separate adult-use transaction for anything additional. This keeps your records clean and ensures you get every discount you are entitled to."

Why two transactions: Ohio DCC requires medical and adult-use purchases to be tracked separately in METRC. Combining them creates a compliance violation.

Tax advantage: Medical purchases are taxed at a lower rate. Processing medical first ensures the patient receives the correct tax treatment.

SECTION FIVE: RETENTION TOUCHPOINTS

Medical patients should be contacted proactively, not just when they walk in.
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Touchpoint 1: Welcome Text (Day 1 after first visit)

"Welcome to The Forest family, [Name]. Your medical needs matter to us. Reply STOP to opt out. Save this number for questions."

Touchpoint 2: Restock Alert (when their preferred strain is back in stock)

"Hi [Name], the [Strain Name] you asked about is back in stock at Cleveland Heights. We held a unit for you until [Date]. Call or stop by."

Touchpoint 3: Limit Reminder (when they are at 75% of ninety-day supply)

"Hi [Name], you are at seventy-five percent of your current ninety-day supply limit. Your limit resets on [Date]. Would you like help planning your next visit?"

Touchpoint 4: Educational Invite (monthly)

"Hi [Name], The Forest is hosting a free 'Cannabis Science for Seniors' seminar at the Cleveland Heights Library on [Date]. RSVP at [Link]. Light refreshments provided."

Touchpoint 5: Birthday Discount

"Happy Birthday, [Name]. As a thank you for being a medical patient, enjoy twenty-five percent off your next visit. Valid for thirty days."

SECTION SIX: RED FLAGS — WHEN TO ESCALATE

Escalate to the Store Manager immediately if:

1. Patient reports a defective product that caused illness or injury.
2. Patient is visibly intoxicated or impaired.
3. Patient's registry card is expired and they demand a sale anyway.
4. Patient asks for products or dosages outside their physician recommendation.
5. Patient expresses suicidal ideation or severe mental distress.
6. Any situation that feels legally or ethically ambiguous.

Escalation script:

"I want to make sure we handle this exactly right. Let me get my manager, who has more experience with this specific situation. One moment, please."

Never say: "I do not know what to do." Say: "I want to get you the best possible answer."

SECTION SEVEN: QUICK REFERENCE CARD

Print this section and laminate it for each register:

Condition	Top Terpene	Top Product	Dosage Rule
Pain	Caryophyllene	The Standard GG4	Start low, titrate up
Sleep	Myrcene	Grön 1:1 Dark Chocolate	Half piece, wait 90 min
Anxiety	Limonene	Grön Pearls (1mg)	One mint, wait 60 min
Nausea	Myrcene	The Botanist 1:1 Tincture	Half dropper, sublingual
Appetite	Myrcene	The Solid OG Kush	One puff, wait 10 min
Localized Pain	N/A	The Standard Relief Balm	Apply thin layer, reapply every 4-6 hr

FINAL PRINCIPLE

Medical patients are not a declining segment to be managed. They are the foundation of this industry. Treat every medical patient like they are the reason this store exists — because they are.